Casey Caster

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Engineering and customer-delivery executive with 15+ years building technical organizations in data platforms, cloud, and fintech. At SingleStore, a cloud-native database company, leads a 32-person engineering organization through a director, managers, and principal architects as chief of staff to the CTO; rescued a failing strategic partner integration worth $30M+ in recurring ARR and drove internal GenAI adoption. At Ripple, grew the global implementation function from 3 project managers to 25, delivered 800+ global implementations, and set network governance with bank C-suite executives.

Core Competencies

- **Technical Customer-Facing Organizations**: Built Ripple's global implementation function: 25 project managers and 75+ engineers and architects delivering 800+ global implementations.
- **Leading Through Leaders & Talent**: Leads a director, two managers, a TPM, and two principal architects (32 people); grew a delivery team from 3 to 25; mentored three future CEOs.
- **Operating Models & Inspection Cadence**: Capacity planning and delivery dashboards; 5x engineering velocity through agile transformation and accountability systems.
- **Executive Advisory & Escalations**: Rescued a failing strategic partner integration ($30M+ ARR); negotiated governance with bank C-suite executives; delivered a $20M+ digital transformation.
- **Data, AI & Cloud**: Cloud-native database company; GenAI adoption, governance, and AI enablement with Claude Code, Amazon Bedrock, and Google Vertex AI; negotiates LLM vendor token pricing; cut cloud spend 50%.
- **Partner Ecosystems & Cross-Functional Influence**: A strategic partner integration, a Japan joint venture, and programs spanning Product, Engineering, and Finance.

Professional Experience

- **SingleStore** **San Francisco, CA**
  Sr Director, Engineering - Internal Services & Technical Program Management (CTO Chief of Staff) *2021-Present*
  Strategy and operations for a cloud-native database company in hypergrowth, reporting to the CPO and then the CTO. Leads seven teams (32 people) through a director, managers, a TPM, and two principal architects; manages the engineering budget with Finance.
  - **Unlocked $30M+ in recurring ARR** by rescuing a failing strategic partner integration through a cross-functional realignment.
  - **Increased engineering velocity 5x** through agile transformation and accountability systems.
  - **Runs engineering capacity planning and delivery dashboards** that give leadership visibility and early course correction.
  - **Drove internal GenAI adoption** with a governance and ops program; leads AI enablement across the development stack, including Claude Code, Amazon Bedrock, and Google Vertex AI.
  - **Negotiates with vendors**, including LLM token pricing and usage commitments.
  - **Cut internal cloud spend by 50%** through cross-team policy reform and usage modeling; built a COGS intelligence engine with Finance.
  - **De-risked M&A** by leading technical due diligence, then integrating acquired teams into core systems and workflows.
  - **Launched an internal development platform**, reducing infrastructure bottlenecks by 70%.

- **Ripple, Inc.** **San Francisco, CA**
  Global Head of Program Management, Customer Success *2016-2020*
  Promoted to lead global delivery for RippleNet and build the customer implementation function.
  - **Delivered 800+ global RippleNet implementations**; led 25 project managers directly and 75+ engineers and architects indirectly.
  - **Cut customer delivery time 75%**, from eight months to eight weeks.
  - **Oversaw a joint venture in Japan** from formation to a strong market position, delivering implementations at 68+ additional banks.
  - **Created the RippleNet Committee**, negotiating with C-suite executives of major banks to govern a network handling millions of transactions.
  - **Negotiated SOWs and MSAs** and built customer care and infrastructure strategy for enterprise customers.
- **Wells Fargo Bank** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Program Manager *2014-2015*
  - **Delivered a $20M+ digital transformation initiative**, coordinating 300+ testers.
  - **Led an upgrade of project portfolio systems** for 10,000+ vendors.
- **Autodesk** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Program Manager, Head of Continuous Improvement *2013-2014*
  - **Led portfolio optimization with $2M+ in savings** for customers across manufacturing, architecture, construction, and media.
- **Engajer** **Mountain View, CA**
  Head of Customer Success *2012-2013*
  - Built and led programs supporting 850+ customers; increased revenue 20% per account with 85% retention and 60% reactivation of dormant accounts.
- **Avanade** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Consultant *2010-2012*
  - Delivered CRM and communications transformations for utilities and healthcare customers; led requirements and business analysis.

Selected Accomplishments

- **Established Ripple's payments network from scratch**: membership scheme, governing body, and business rules; enrolled the first 12 banks and grew membership past 200.
- **Led the design and deployment of Ford's North American CRM platform** across headquarters and dealerships in the US and Canada.
- **Mentored dozens of team members**, three of whom became CEOs at other companies.

Technical Toolkit

- **Cloud & AI**: AWS, GCP, Azure, Amazon Bedrock, Google Vertex AI, Claude Code, Cursor
- **Data & Delivery**: SQL, Looker, Tableau, Power BI, Jira, Confluence, GitHub, CI/CD, Salesforce

Education & Certifications

- **Executive MBA** – Cornell University (Johnson) and Queen's University (Smith), dual degree
- **BS, Electronic Engineering Technology** – DeVry University, Pomona, CA
- **Project Management Professional (PMP)** – Project Management Institute

References

- Available upon request.